

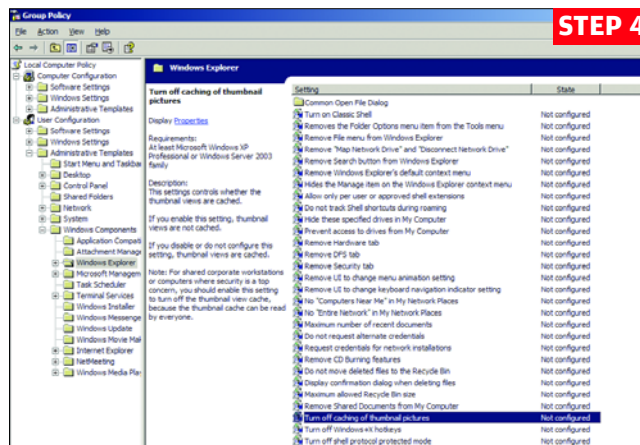
and click on the '+' sign to locate the key that says "OpenWithList". In the right pane, you'll see a list with the programs in the list, like 'explorer.exe' or 'notepad.exe'. Simply select the option you want to discard and delete it.

If you inadvertently remove an entry that you would need, you needn't fret; when you right-click a file there will be an option in the "Open With" extension that will let you choose any program on your computer to open the file. Once used, the option will reappear in the list of associated programs.

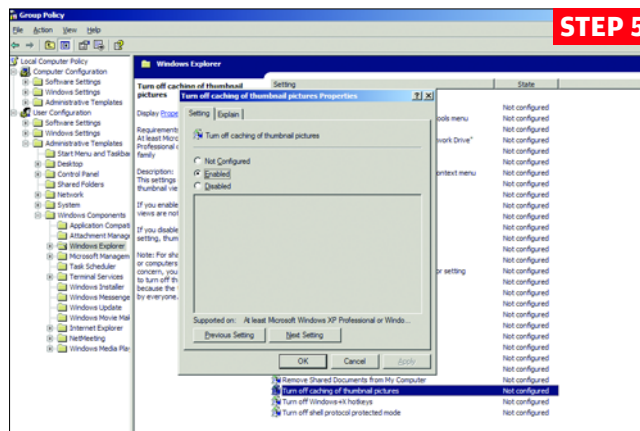
Turn off Thumbs.db

 Thumbs.db are files which are created in a folder with movies or pictures in them so you can view a piece of their content without actually opening them. In a nutshell, it is an option that allows you to have a thumbnail view of your files. This file makes sure you don't have to reload a thumbnail every time you browse a particular folder.

If you edit a lot of stuff on your machine, it could become a tad annoying to see them pop up in all your



Right-click on 'Turn off thumbnail pictures'



After the right-click, select 'Enable' from the radio buttons in the menu

image and movie folders.

Getting rid of this file is easy. Go to Start > Run, and type in "gpedit.msc". Click 'OK', and the Group Policy Editor will open. Go to User Configuration > Administrative Template > Windows Components > Windows Explorer. A rather long list will show up in the menu on the right. Double-click 'Turn off caching of thumbnail pictures'. Enabling this will do your job—no more Thumbs.db in your folders!

The above solution works for XP Pro users. Users with XP Home Edition will need to select Control Panel > Folder Options > View > Do Not Cache Thumbnails.

A point to note is that disabling thumbnail caching will slow down opening folders in thumbnail view.

Select The Theme And Colour Scheme For The Welcome Screen

 With this tweak, you'll be able to modify which colour selection of the

default theme shows up when your computer's startup screen is displayed. Start the Registry Editor and navigate to HKEY_USERS\ .DEFAULT\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\ThemeManager, and locate the key 'ColorName'. Change its value from 'NormalColor' to 'Metallic'. Exit the Registry Editor and restart your computer. Your new colour scheme will come into effect! Of course, to go back to the old colour scheme, just change 'Metallic' back to 'NormalColor'.

Enable ClearType In The Welcome Screen

 Microsoft ClearType technology greatly increases clarity of text on laptop LCD screens. By default, this feature does not start until after you log on. But with this tweak, you'll be able to make it start just as Windows loads, so it will be enabled on the Welcome screen.

Start the Registry Editor and go to HKEY_USERS\ .DEFAULT\Control Panel\Desktop. Locate the key 'FontSmoothingType' and change its value to '2'.

Get Rid Of The 'Go' Button

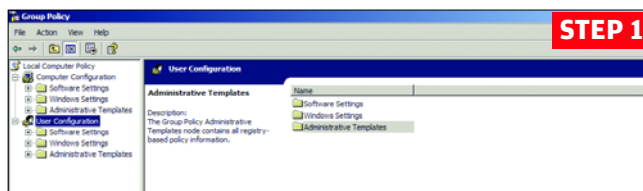
 When you add the address bar to the taskbar, or even the one in Internet Explorer, you can turn off the 'Address' button by right-clicking on the bar and de-selecting 'Show Title'.

However, to get rid of the 'Go' button, you have to do the following: Start Internet Explorer, click Tools > Internet Options, and select the 'Advanced' tab. Scroll down the list of options until you find the 'Show Go Button in Address Bar' checkbox. De-select it and you're done.

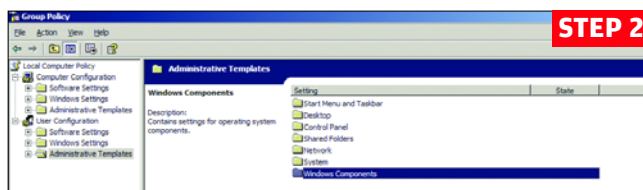
Turn Off System Restore

 XP includes the System Restore utility, which can help you roll your computer back to a pre-defined point in time, removing all changes made to the system since that point.

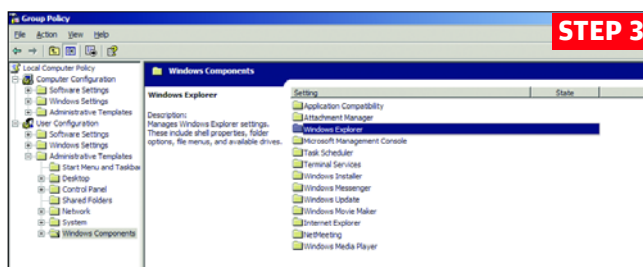
This can be an extremely useful feature for rescuing your PC from viruses or problems with faulty



To turn off Thumbs.db, start with 'gpedit.msc'—the Group Policy Editor



Select 'Windows Components'



Select 'Windows Explorer'